

## Akeso

## One more interim OS look added to HARMONi-3; new US\$380mn ATM filed by Summit

Akeso's US partner Summit reported 2Q26 results alongside two items of primary relevance to the ivonescimab narrative: an updated schedule for the global Ph3 HARMONi-3 OS (overall survival) analysis, and the filing of a prospectus supplement for a new at-the-market (ATM) equity issue program of up to US \$380mn. On HARMONi-3, Summit's management confirmed that enrollment is complete in both the squamous (1Q26) and non-squamous cohorts (2Q26), but acknowledged that event rates have slowed, pushing the timing of the squamous PFS analysis towards the middle/back end of 2H26. Management also disclosed for the first time that there would be a second interim look at the overall survival (OS) of the HARMONi-3 squamous cohort in 1H27, in addition to the PFS analysis accompanying the early interim OS analysis in 2H26. Management emphasized that the alpha spend on the 2H26 OS analysis will be very small, whereas the OS analysis in 1H27 would be better powered.

- **On the squamous cohort, Summit expects to reach the required event count for the primary PFS analysis in 2H26, accompanied by an early interim OS look.** While no specific disclosure plan has been set, management characterized this OS look as supportive, and stated that the alpha spend will be minimal. The stated expectation is evidence of curve separation rather than a powered hazard ratio, and management has said that it expects to communicate a directional trend. For the second interim OS analysis for the squamous cohort in 1H27, median follow-up is guided to low-20s months, a level management explicitly benchmarks against the 21-month median follow-up in HARMONi-6 and the ~23-month Western follow-up in the updated HARMONi cut. Final OS remains further out. For the non-squamous cohort, Summit still expects the PFS analysis to happen in 1H27. But it is not clear whether the PFS analysis of the non-squamous cohort will be earlier or later than the second OS analysis of the squamous cohort.
- **It is not clear whether the FDA will need additional review time or whether there will be an ODAC (Oncologic Drugs Advisory Committee).** Summit's management acknowledged that it had provided the additional OS analysis of HARMONi to the FDA but it is up to the agency whether it needs more review time, which might push PDUFA to a later date. In addition, management said it is up to the FDA whether there will be an ODAC involved for the review.
- **Summit ended 2Q26 with approximately US\$690.7mn in cash** versus US \$598.7mn at 1Q26, an increase of US\$92mn driven by US\$231mn raised under the prior ATM against roughly US\$140mn of operating cash use. Non-GAAP quarterly opex rose to US\$151.8mn in 2Q26 on higher R&D for running trials. Against that, the US\$380mn ATM covers a meaningful portion of the funding gap to support sustainable trial development for ivonescimab. For Akeso, the overseas commercialization of ivonescimab is the primary route to future milestone and royalty economics.

## Overweight

9926.HK, 9926 HK

Price (24 Jul 26):HK\$99.50

Price Target (Dec-26):HK\$162.00

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## Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

### **Akeso** (*Overweight; Price Target: HK\$162.00*)

#### **Investment Thesis**

Akeso is a commercial-stage biotech in China and a leader in bispecific antibody. Though the market appears to be unsatisfied with HARMONi-6 OS data reported at the ASCO '26 plenary session, we believe the stock still has upside at the current level, driven by: (1) AK104 (PD-1/CTLA-4): Indication expansion into a broad range of large markets in China, which we expect should generate >Rmb7bn in China peak sales; (2) AK104 started two global registrational trials in gastric cancer and liver cancer, opening up ex-China potential; (3) AK112 (PD-1/VEGF) should unleash solid sales momentum with >Rmb7bn peak sales in China alone. Though it is not certain whether HARMONi-3 interim OS analysis in 2H26 will hit statistical significance, we currently model its ex-China peak sales of US\$4 bn; (4) other bispecific antibody assets in oncology, immunology, and CNS provide additional pipeline value.

#### **Valuation**

Our Dec-26 PT of HK\$162 is based on our DCF valuation. We estimate free cash flow for Akeso until 2034, assuming a terminal growth rate of 3.0% and a WACC of 9.6%.

#### DCF valuation

| WACC Assumptions         |              |
|--------------------------|--------------|
| Risk-free rate           | 3.8%         |
| Market risk              | 6.6%         |
| Beta                     | 1.0          |
| <b>Cost of equity</b>    | <b>10.4%</b> |
| Cost of debt             | 3.0%         |
| Liabilities as a % of EV | 10%          |
| <b>WACC</b>              | <b>9.6%</b>  |

|                                     |                |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|
| WACC                                | 9.6%           |
| Terminal growth rate                | 3.0%           |
| Terminal Present Value              | 80,597         |
| PV Cash Flow                        | 35,486         |
| <b>Enterprise value</b>             | <b>116,084</b> |
| + Cash balance                      | 10,466         |
| - LT Debt                           | (4,541)        |
| - Minority Interest                 | (131)          |
| Early pipeline assets               | 9,500          |
| <b>Akeso equity value (RMB mn)</b>  | <b>131,640</b> |
| <b>+ SMMT equity value (Rmb mn)</b> | <b>3,911</b>   |
| Total equity value (Rmb mn)         | 135,551        |
| Shares Outstanding (MM)             | 921            |
| Per Share Value (RMB)               | 147.2          |
| <b>Per Share Value (HKD)</b>        | <b>162</b>     |

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

#### Risks to Rating and Price Target

Key downside risks include: (1) pipeline development setbacks; and (2) sales of AK104 or AK112 are below our expectations.

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Akeso (9926.HK, 9926 HK) Price Chart



| Date      | Rating | Price (HK\$) | Price Target (HK\$) |
|-----------|--------|--------------|---------------------|
| 14-Oct-23 | OW     | 39.05        | 57                  |
| 08-Nov-23 | OW     | 47.90        | 59                  |
| 11-Sep-24 | OW     | 55.70        | 68                  |
| 31-Oct-24 | OW     | 65.80        | 74                  |
| 08-Jan-25 | OW     | 57.40        | 76                  |
| 01-Apr-25 | OW     | 76.20        | 88                  |
| 24-Apr-25 | OW     | 92.90        | 110                 |
| 03-Jun-25 | OW     | 75.00        | 99                  |
| 28-Aug-25 | OW     | 157.00       | 166                 |
| 18-Dec-25 | OW     | 117.10       | 149                 |
| 30-Mar-26 | OW     | 126.40       | 162                 |

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.  
Initiated coverage May 27, 2020. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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